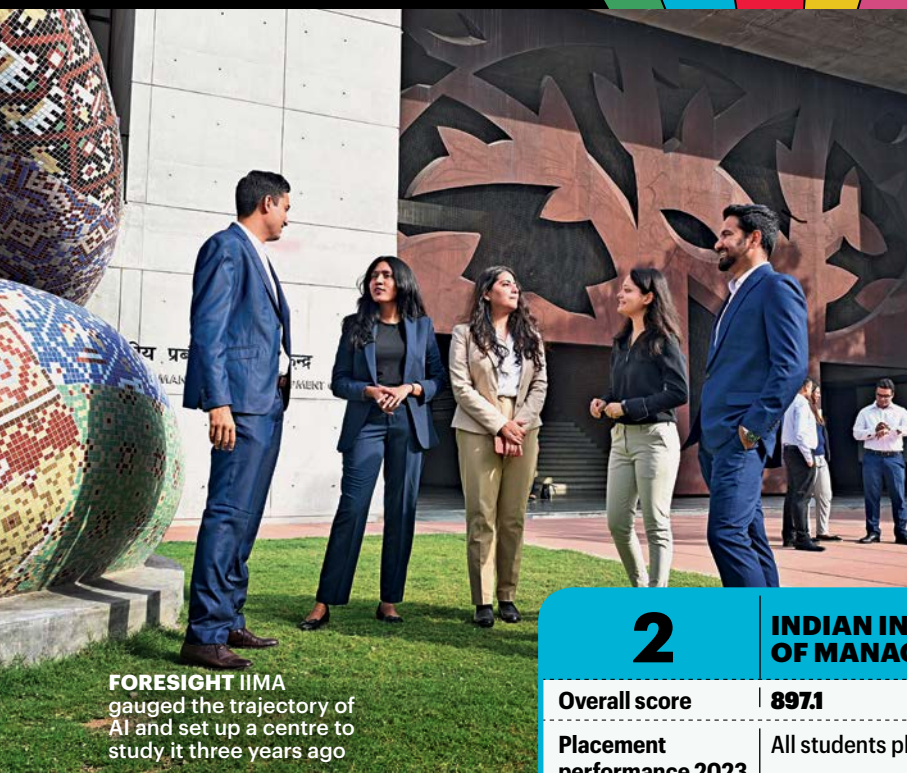




**FORESIGHT** IIMA gauged the trajectory of AI and set up a centre to study it three years ago

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### THE REALISATION THAT

India is not the only country for which the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad (IIMA) produces leaders keeps Bharat Bhasker, its new Director, on his toes. "The world is changing at a rapid pace. We're going to be at the centre of the world [economy]. Everybody is de-risking from China and it's time for us to [grab] that opportunity," he says.

To ensure that the opportunity isn't missed, IIMA has remained steadfast in its commitment to mould industry-ready students, says Anirudh Rapole, a student of the postgraduate diploma in management for executives programme, who has taken a break from a well-paying job. "[IIMA's] emphasis on academic rigour and experiential learning fosters a transformative journey, where students are immersed in real-world decision-making scenarios. This experience equips graduates with invaluable

skills," he says.

Talking about real-world scenarios, IIMA opened up just such an opportunity for Dwibesh Nath, another student. "Within a month of our study at IIMA we got the opportunity to be a part of the round table conference of policymaking proposals for India's G20 leadership, interact with influential individuals like the new US Ambassador to India, and participate in the implementation planning programme of the National Education Policy," he says.

Bhasker, meanwhile, is focussed on the future, which means embracing technological change. "Tradi-

tional management schools have not been able to cope up and create enough of that manpower. It's all about creating a balance between age-old leadership techniques and values and a tech-centric curriculum," he says.

But, the Director is not too affected by the frenetic pace of that change, especially with the launch of programs like ChatGPT. "ChatGPT didn't take me by surprise," he says. That's because IIMA gauged AI's trajectory three years ago and

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### INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AHMEDABAD

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|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Overall score</b>                              | <b>897.1</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Placement performance 2023</b>                 | All students placed across 23 industries                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Campus experience</b>                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Facilities on campus include the Vikram Sarabhai Library; student, faculty and staff housing</li> <li>Also has crèche, indoor and outdoor sports complexes, yoga room, canteens, pharmacy and general store</li> </ul> |
| <b>New initiatives (digital/entrepreneurship)</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Launched Online@IIMA, a single gateway to access all online programmes</li> <li>A slew of online certification courses to help professionals be future-ready</li> </ul>                                                |

started a centre for data science and AI that studies the impact of such technologies on businesses.

Now, the focus is on IIMA's presence online. "There's no substitute for in-class learning, but we want to reach students who might have missed the bus. We call it democratisation of management education, because many people will never be able to get admission at IIMA. We provide a variety of Management courses on an online platform for free as we don't want them to stop educating themselves," he says.

— PRERNA LIDHOO